
The NJ Attorney Review & Closing Cost Cheat Sheet

What every New Jersey home buyer and seller should know before signing anything

A FREE GUIDE FROM SHORE PROPERTIES REFERRAL LLC

Inside: the 3-business-day attorney review period explained, what can go wrong during it, a full breakdown of buyer and seller closing costs in New Jersey, and a quick-reference cost table you can bring to your first conversation with an agent.

Shore Properties Referral LLC — John Grossi, NJ License #2185031

(848) 216-8484 | John.T.Grossi@gmail.com | johnthomasgrossi.github.io/john-grossi-referrals

1. What Is Attorney Review?

New Jersey is one of the few states where a signed purchase contract isn't the final word. Once a buyer and seller accept an offer, both sides typically get a **three-business-day attorney review period**. During this window, either attorney can cancel the deal outright, or request changes to the contract terms — no penalty, no forfeited deposit.

Many first-time buyers and sellers don't realize this period exists until they're already in it, which can feel unsettling. In practice, it's a protection built into how real estate works in NJ, and a good agent will walk you through it before you ever sign.

How the clock works

- The three-day clock starts the day after the contract is signed by both parties (weekends and holidays don't count).
- Attorneys typically send a cancellation or modification letter to keep the review period open, or notify that the contract is approved as-is.
- If no letter is sent by either side, the contract becomes final at the end of the third business day.

What can happen during attorney review

- **Contract is approved as-is** — the most common outcome when both sides negotiated fairly upfront.
- **Terms are renegotiated** — financing contingencies, inspection language, closing dates, or included items (appliances, fixtures) get adjusted.
- **Either party walks away** — rare, but it's the safety valve that makes NJ's process buyer- and seller-friendly.

Shore Properties Referral LLC — John Grossi, NJ License #2185031

(848) 216-8484 | John.T.Grossi@gmail.com | johnthomasgrossi.github.io/john-grossi-referrals

2. Buyer Closing Costs in New Jersey

Buyers typically budget **2%–3% of the purchase price** for closing costs, on top of the down payment. The exact number depends on your loan type, lender, and town. Here's what that usually includes:

Cost	Typical Range	Notes
Attorney fee	\$700 – \$1,500	Flat fee is common in NJ
Home inspection	\$400 – \$800+	Add radon/oil tank sweep in older towns
Loan origination & lender fees	0.5% – 1% of loan	Varies by lender
Appraisal	\$450 – \$700	Required by most lenders
Title insurance & search	\$1,000 – \$2,500	One-time cost, based on price
Recording fees	\$150 – \$300	County-specific
Prepaid escrow (taxes/insurance)	Varies	Lender-dependent
Homeowners insurance (1st yr.)	\$800 – \$1,800	NJ shore towns run higher

Tip: get pre-approved (not just pre-qualified) before you shop. A pre-approval means a lender has verified your income, credit, and assets — sellers in competitive NJ towns often won't take an offer seriously without one.

Shore Properties Referral LLC — John Grossi, NJ License #2185031

(848) 216-8484 | John.T.Grossi@gmail.com | johnthomasgrossi.github.io/john-grossi-referrals

3. Seller Closing Costs in New Jersey

Sellers typically net **6%–10% less** than the sale price once commissions, transfer fees, and attorney costs are factored in. Here's the breakdown:

Cost	Typical Range	Notes
Real estate commission	5% – 6% of sale price	Split between buyer & seller agents
NJ Realty Transfer Fee	~0.4% – 1%+ of price	Sliding scale; rises with sale price
Attorney fee	\$700 – \$1,500	Flat fee is common in NJ
Outstanding mortgage payoff	Varies	Includes any prepayment penalty
Title-related repairs/liens	Varies	Resolved before or at closing
Recording & misc. fees	\$150 – \$300	County-specific

The NJ Realty Transfer Fee is calculated on a sliding scale based on sale price, with additional fees for properties over \$1 million. Your closing attorney will calculate your exact fee.

Two things that catch NJ sellers off guard

- **Property taxes vary town to town** — and buyers will factor your town's tax rate into their offer. Know your number before you list.
- **Older homes often need a CO (Certificate of Occupancy) inspection** depending on your municipality — ask your agent early so it doesn't delay closing.

Shore Properties Referral LLC — John Grossi, NJ License #2185031

(848) 216-8484 | John.T.Grossi@gmail.com | johnthomasgrossi.github.io/john-grossi-referrals

Ready to talk to a vetted local agent?

Shore Properties Referral LLC connects NJ buyers and sellers with experienced local agents who handle the details above every day. There's no cost to you — and no obligation.

(848) 216-8484 | John.T.Grossi@gmail.com

johnthomasgrossi.github.io/john-grossi-referrals

Shore Properties Referral LLC does not list, show, or represent buyers or sellers directly in real estate transactions. We connect consumers with independently licensed, vetted real estate agents in New Jersey. All figures in this guide are general estimates for informational purposes only and are not a substitute for advice from a licensed NJ real estate attorney. NJ License #2185031.